

on the Formatting toolbar. This opens the Styles and Formatting toolbox, which you can use to quickly set dozens of different styles. In order to apply a style to text, just highlight the desired text and then double-click the style.

The formatting toolbar, from left to right, has options to quickly change the font type, font size, set bold, italics and underline, paragraph alignment (left, center, right, justified), add numbering, bullets, decrease and increase indents, change the text colour, background colour, and add a fill to the page or paragraph. For even more control over the formatting, you can open up the Format menu from the Menu bar and change character, paragraph and page formatting.

We've decided that office suites are software that you should just use, rather than read a lot of theory about. So instead of trying to explain the function of each menu item and expect you to figure out how and when to use them, we've decided to present you with a lot of little tutorials that will not only tell you how to use the functions of Writer, but also show you when and why they are used. Needless to say, the largest section of this chapter follows.

1.3 Tutorials

1.3.1 Opening And Saving

In order to open a new text document, go to **File > New > Text Document**, or just press **[Ctrl] + [N]**. Although this may sound like a pointless tip, the reason we mention it is because with Oo, you can create a new file in any form—database, text, spreadsheet, presentation, etc.—from any of the office tools. So if you choose to open, say, a new spreadsheet from within Writer, it opens Calc automatically.

The first time you want to save the document, just press **[Ctrl] + [S]** as usual, but then you have to choose the format in which to save. By default, Writer will save documents in the .odt